



MANY ECONOMISTS across the political spectrum are skeptical that President Trump’s chaotic trade war will usher in the production of significantly more U.S. goods or jobs. Above, a view of the Port of Los Angeles.

Trump’s defiance of the courts escalates

By Kevin Rector
and Michael Wilner

WASHINGTON — It was just the latest example of President Trump, still in the infancy of his second term, appearing to plow through direct orders from a U.S. court. But it was also one of the sharpest moments yet of a federal judge losing patience.

U.S. District Judge Paula Xinis had asked what the administration had done, if anything, to follow a ruling from the highest court in the land, and reached a stark conclusion.

“To date, nothing has been done,” Xinis told the Justice Department lawyer before her Tuesday. “Nothing.”

Less than 24 hours later, a second federal judge said he would be launching proceedings to determine whether to hold Trump administration officials in criminal contempt for ignoring an order of his to not remove certain Venezuelan migrants from the country.

U.S. District Judge James E. Boasberg wrote Wednesday that the administration’s actions had shown “willful disregard” for his order, and that he believed there was sufficient “probable cause” to find them in contempt.

In the case before Xinis, the Supreme Court had ordered the administration last week to “facilitate” the return of a Maryland resident named Kilmar Armando Abrego Garcia, whom it had deported to a notorious El Salvador prison despite an earlier court order barring such a move.

[See Trump, A6]

Federal judges demand administration comply with orders on deportations; experts warn of constitutional crisis



PRESIDENT TRUMP, seen at the White House, has defied court orders in the case of Kilmar Armando Abrego Garcia.

Toxic algae bloom is taking toll on pelicans

Sickened seabirds are filling up area wildlife rehab centers, and chicks are starving.

By Grace Toohey

Brown pelicans across Southern California are filling up wildlife rehabilitation centers, either sick or starving — a dual crisis that wildlife experts believe could be linked to a massive toxic algae bloom.

For the last month, hundreds of seabirds have been poisoned by domoic acid, a neurotoxin produced in harmful algae blooms that are consumed by filter-feeding fish, such as anchovies and sardines. The small fish aren’t affected by the toxins, but many seabirds and marine mammals that feed on the fish are, and the sickness can be deadly. More than 100 area sea lions have been sickened and killed by the toxins over the last few months.

[See Pelicans, A12]



FRIENDS Stacy Salazar, left, and Cassandra Leviste came to Idyllic on March 29 specifically to check out the Genic booth, which had been popping up on TikTok.

Gen Z is obsessed with two UCLA grads’ ‘high-angle’ photo booth

By Kailyn Brown

On a recent Saturday afternoon in the Arts District, a group of seven friends — plus a tiny dog — contorted and twisted their bodies to fit inside a light brown, 8-foot-tall box that had a mirrored door inscribed with the words “Memory Archive.”

Once they were all mostly inside, they looked up toward a Canon DSLR camera that was peeking out of a small hole. They posed — smiling brightly, forming their fingers into peace signs and heart shapes, and holding the dog in the air like Baby Simba — as the shutter clicked eight times. They then stepped out of the booth, selected their favorite

shots at a kiosk and waited about 60 seconds for the photos to develop.

The energetic group of new friends, most of whom had met only a few hours before at a rave, had stumbled upon the photo booth as they were grabbing food at Idyllic cafe and decided to commemorate the moment. They gushed over the re-

[See Photo booths, A9]

Will trade war upend global order — and boost China?

The risks are not just economic, experts say. Tariff tensions could undermine ‘the core of American power.’

By Jenny Jarvie

As President Trump pushes the United States into a trade war with China, the trade-offs are often described as higher consumer prices and inflation versus the potential to bring back manufacturing jobs that Americans lost over the last three decades.

But the economic showdown between Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping is about much more than the price of an iPhone or a pair of Hoka shoes.

An extreme, protracted trade war between the two global superpowers brings profound risk that, economists say, could destabilize the world economy, trigger a global recession and plunge millions into poverty. It could also transform the balance of global power in ways that fundamentally undermine U.S. standing in the

world.

“There is a good chance that this is something that isn’t just printed in the newspapers today, but is in history books decades from now,” said Jason Furman, professor of the Practice of Economic Policy at Harvard Kennedy School and former chair of then-President Obama’s Council of Economic Advisors.

“This undermines the core of American power,” Furman said. “The United States has had on its side of the ledger a set of alliances that are much deeper, much more enduring than any alliances that China has. This is severely testing that big advantage that the United States has had by infuriating our allies in a way that we may not be able to recover from.”

Trump has stated that his goal — a key plank of his “America first” agenda — is to invigorate U.S. manufacturing. “Jobs and factories,” he has promised, “will come roaring back into our country.”

But many economists across the political spectrum are skeptical that the chaotic trade war Trump

[See Trade war, A4]

Newsom sues the president, says his tariffs are illegal

By Taryn Luna

California Gov. Gavin Newsom on Wednesday announced a lawsuit contesting President Trump’s executive authority to enact international tariffs without congressional support, which he likened to the commander in chief taking a “wrecking ball” to America’s global reputation.

The legal action argues that the International

Emergency Economic Powers Act that Trump cited to impose tariffs does not grant the president the ability to unilaterally adopt tariffs on goods imported to the U.S. The suit from California is the first challenge from any state against Trump’s trade policy.

“No state is poised to lose more than the state of California,” Newsom said about Trump’s tariffs. “That’s why we’re asserting ourselves on behalf of 40 million Americans.”

The case marks the first time Newsom has taken a lead role in any of the now 15 lawsuits that California has filed against the current Trump administration, signaling a deviation from his more reserved approach to the president during Trump’s second term. Until now, state Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta has acted as the face of California’s legal battles against the federal government, while Newsom has generally maintained a distance from the back-and-forth court tussles.

Newsom said he chose to take action after absorbing the effects of the tariffs over the last few weeks.

“He is betraying the people that supported him,” Newsom said. “Donald Trump has turned his back on his supporters.”

Under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act, Trump has implemented 10% baseline tariffs on all imported goods, higher taxes on goods from Mexico, Canada and China, and specific levies on products and materials such as autos and aluminum. The president threatened and then paused additional tariffs on other nations until

[See Lawsuit, A12]

A redefinition for species act

Trump administration proposes changing the meaning of “harm” in the bedrock environmental law. **NATION, A5**

LAFD helmet inspires Kings

Firefighters’ hat that recalls sacrifice and courage goes to the top player after every win at home. **SPORTS, B10**

WGA ices out Scorsese film

Writers are banned from joining the project because of its tie to producer Randall Emmett. **BUSINESS, A8**

Weather

A shower in places. L.A. Basin: 65/54. **B6**

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